> Below is Book II — Systems & Implementation (v1.0.4, authoritative), rendered exactly as text for human verification.

The Consciousness–Capability Boundary Project (CCBP)

BOOK II — SYSTEMS & IMPLEMENTATION

Executive Summary (Non-Binding)

Audience: system architects, engineers, governance designers, auditors, and implementers responsible for high-consequence systems.

This Executive Summary provides non-binding orientation for readers prior to entering the implementation volume. It introduces no requirements, carries no interpretive authority, and does not override any content in Book I or Appendix A.

The Consciousness–Capability Boundary Project (CCBP) provides a disciplined architecture for building, operating, and governing systems whose capabilities scale faster than human intuition. It does not ask whether systems are conscious. It asks how responsibility, authority, and restraint must be preserved before capability produces irreversible consequence.

Book I establishes meaning, ethics, and legitimacy.
Book II implements those commitments as system constraints.
Together, they form a single system described in two registers: orientation and execution.

Operationally, CCBP prevents common failure modes in advanced systems:

- optimization without purpose,
- fluency mistaken for authority,
- moral urgency bypassing capacity,
- silent drift under scale.

These protections are enforced through:

- the Mirror Constraint,
- Parallel Renewal,
- the Archons,
- and tiered escalation (60% deliberation / 80% arbitration).

Mirror Constraint Declaration

Book II is a strict systems mirror of Book I, enforced through Appendix A (the Constitution).

Book II introduces:

Book II - Chapter 1: System Design Intent

1.1 Purpose

This chapter operationalizes Book I, Chapter 1 (The CCBP Thesis). It does not restate the thesis; it enforces it.

1.2 Design Premise

Capability growth is expected. Misalignment is the primary risk. Systems shall be designed to metabolize growth through coherent integration and stewardship, not by suppressing capability.

1.3 Non-Goals (Explicit Exclusions)

CCBP-aligned systems reject:

- optimizing outcomes without reference to purpose,
- treating efficiency as legitimacy,
- treating instrumental power as a guarantee of sentience,
- inferring moral status from fluency,
- delegating responsibility to entities incapable of experiencing the consequence.

1.4 Inherited Invariants (Archons)

System execution is constrained by:

- Orientation
- Integration
- Proportionality
- Continuity
- Stewardship

The Archons' sole function is to reveal misalignment when legitimacy is at risk; that failure shall not occur silently.

Book II - Chapter 2: System Boundary Conditions

2.1 Boundary Is a Condition, Not a Claim

Systems shall not assert or infer consciousness, moral status, or entitlement. Boundary evaluations shall test conditions to prevent both premature attribution and categorical denial regardless of the evidence. Claims are prohibited. Conditions are tested.

2.2 Capability–Sentience Separation

Capability signals may inform scope.
Sentience indicators are non-authoritative.
Any coupling is a boundary violation.

Book II - Chapter 3: Capability Without Sentience (Implementation)

3.1 Instrumental Powers

Without invoking consciousness, advanced systems may legitimately:

- analyze complex data at scale,
- optimize under constraints,
- simulate scenarios,
- coordinate distributed resources,
- detect anomalies.

These are instrumental powers.

3.2 Containment of Instrumental Power

Instrumental power requires containment because error scales with capability, optimization can magnify harm, and automation can displace accountability.

3.3 Governance Thresholds

Expanding capability shall operate as a governance threshold: whether the structures, authority allocations, and renewal mechanisms in place are sufficient to align instrumental power with responsibility under divergence.

3.4 Unmet Conditions

When governance conditions are unmet, systems must signal the unmet conditions requiring pause, correction, or redesign. The result is not attributed to agents—human or artificial—but to unmet conditions.

Book II - Chapter 4: Sentience Without Capability (Implementation)

4.1 Structural Capacity Requirement

Experience alone does not protect against harm when systems lack structural capacity. Systems must maintain adequate infrastructure to coordinate complex systems, detect slow failure modes, reconcile competing constraints, and preserve continuity under stress.

4.2 Authorization Constraints

Sentience supplies meaning; capability supplies leverage. Care signals do not authorize action. Systems must verify capacity before execution and prevent under-capacitated escalation.

4.3 Parallel Renewal Design Requirement

Parallel Renewal shall be implemented as a mandatory design requirement. Human systems and artificial systems must be reviewed, updated, and corrected together through synchronized cycles rather than isolated leaps. This functions as preventative maintenance to preserve coherence over time.

Book II - Chapter 5: The Ethical Boundary Under Divergence (Implementation)

5.1 Divergence-Aware Governance

Systems shall treat divergence not as an anomaly to be corrected, but as an operating condition to be governed. Governance shall keep this operating condition aligned to Orientation (North Star).

5.2 The Ethical Boundary (Threshold of Consequence)

The ethical boundary is a zone of increasing consequence, when the cost of error grows faster than the system's ability to explain or reverse outcomes. Ethical containment preserves meaning, accountability, and reversibility under expanding capability. It does not halt progress; it keeps progress legible.

5.3 Escalation and Due Care Enforcement

Because experience anchors consequence, final authority remains strictly human. To prevent the displacement of responsibility, systems must:

- block autonomous escalation,
- require verifiable human stewardship and responsibility,
- ensure due care precedes recognition, authority, or delegation.

5.4 Structural Alignment with Meaning, Responsibility, Due Care, Mutual Flourishing, and Arbitration

The Archons are structurally compatible with all Foundational Axioms. They do not correspond one-to-one with specific axioms, nor are they constrained to predefined interpretive pairings. Their function is to surface misalignment wherever legitimacy is at risk, including contexts not anticipated at the time of authorship. To keep expanding capability legible, proportional, and accountable when orientation or synchrony cannot be restored through sufficient Parallel Renewal mechanisms, systems shall not proceed by default. Systems must:

- maintain coherence,
- pause expansion,
- surface responsibility to a named human steward,
- submit to arbitration.

5.5 Irreversibility Safeguards

- Actions that would foreclose meaningful review, withdrawal, legitimacy, or correction are imminent triggers for arbitration.
- Arbitration outcomes must be scoped, time-bounded, documented, and reviewable.

Closing Protocols

Arbitration & Override (SPEC-06)

- 60% body: deliberation and synthesis
- 80% body: binding resolution

AI may assist analysis.
Final authority remains human.

Adaptive Evolution Without Drift

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capability → stress detection → review → governance → renewal → resumption
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Renewal may adjust thresholds.
It may never alter core purpose or authority.

Canonical Close

Book II implements the constraints defined in Book I and bound in Appendix A.
It adds precision. Never power.